

The Reading Content Universe

A brainstorming framework for creating a constant supply of interesting articles around reading and speed reading

The Core Idea

If the goal is to promote reading and speed reading, don't make the niche simply "reading." Instead, build a content universe around the act of reading. Reading becomes the central character, while history, psychology, science, technology, culture, productivity and philosophy provide endless storylines.

■ History of Reading

One of the richest sources of fascinating stories.

- When did humans start reading silently?
- Why did ancient writing have no spaces between words?
- Why were books chained to library shelves?
- How expensive was a book 1,000 years ago?
- How Gutenberg changed the world
- The history of newspapers, paperbacks and libraries
- Reading during wars and in prisons
- Reading culture in ancient India

■ Psychology of Reading

Excellent for explaining why reading works and why it can be difficult.

- Why do we forget most of what we read?
- Why do we hear a voice inside our head while reading?
- Why does reading fiction make imaginary people feel real?
- Why do we get distracted after five minutes?
- Paper vs screen reading
- Why stories are easier to remember than facts
- Why rereading can feel easier
- What happens in the brain when we read

■ Speed Reading

The practical pillar, but with a focus on science rather than repetitive tips.

- How fast can humans actually read?
- Why do we subvocalize?
- Can you really read 1,000 words per minute?
- Does speed reading reduce comprehension?

- Why do we reread sentences?
- Peripheral vision and reading speed
- Skimming vs scanning vs speed reading
- How journalists, lawyers and students handle huge amounts of text

■ The History of Famous Books

Tell stories about books rather than simply reviewing them.

- The book that took decades to write
- The book that was banned for years
- Books that changed countries
- Books rejected dozens of times
- Books that predicted the future
- Books written during wars
- Books famous only after their author's death
- The world's oldest surviving books

■ Reading Around the World

Explore how different societies teach, value and practice reading.

- Why Japan has a strong reading culture
- How Finland teaches children to read
- The world's unusual libraries
- Countries with high literacy rates
- How reading was taught before modern schools
- Reading culture in ancient India
- Palm-leaf manuscripts
- Nalanda and the history of libraries

■ Reading vs Technology

A constantly renewing category because technology keeps changing.

- Are smartphones killing our attention span?
- Is TikTok changing how we read?
- E-books vs physical books
- Can AI help you read faster?
- Are book summaries replacing books?
- Will AI make reading less important?
- Why we scroll but struggle to read 20 pages
- Why online reading encourages skimming

■ Weird Reading Experiments

Turn advice into stories by testing reading habits yourself.

- I read for 30 minutes without checking my phone
- I read 100 pages in one day
- I tried reading with zero subvocalization
- I compared 200, 300 and 500 WPM
- I replaced 30 minutes of scrolling with reading for a week
- I read only physical books for a week
- I stopped highlighting everything
- I read a book I completely disagreed with

■■ The Secret Life of Books

Take ordinary reading features and turn them into mysteries.

- Why are books rectangular?
- Why do books have page numbers?
- Who invented the bookmark?
- Why do books have indexes?
- Why are chapters numbered?
- Why do we read left to right?
- Why do books have tables of contents?
- Why do we say “read between the lines”?

■■■ Reading for Students

Highly practical and naturally connected to speed reading.

- How to read a textbook efficiently
- How to read before an exam
- How to remember what you read
- How to take notes without copying everything
- How to read research papers
- How to deal with difficult textbooks
- How to finish a 300-page book
- How to balance academic and recreational reading

■ Philosophy of Reading

More thoughtful essays that make the reader question their habits.

- Why do we read?
- Can a book change your personality?

- Is reading an escape or an education?
- One book deeply vs ten superficially
- Do you really need to finish every book?
- Can you understand a person through their bookshelf?
- Why do fictional characters feel real?
- Is rereading more valuable than reading something new?

The Reading Universe: Suggested Content Mix

Pillar	Approx. share	Purpose
Fascinating stories & history	30%	Make reading culturally and historically interesting
Psychology & neuroscience	25%	Explain how reading and attention work
Speed-reading techniques	20%	Give readers practical skills
Experiments & challenges	15%	Create relatable, story-driven content
Philosophy / opinion	10%	Make readers think more deeply about reading

The Content Engine

The trick is to turn one reading concept into many different stories. For example, “subvocalization” can become a whole mini-series:

- What is subvocalization?
- Why does your brain talk while you read?
- Can you learn to stop subvocalizing?
- Does subvocalization actually slow reading?
- The history of silent reading
- Why speed-reading courses tell you to eliminate your inner voice
- I tried reading without subvocalizing
- Can you read faster than you can speak?
- What happens to comprehension when you suppress your inner voice?
- Is speed reading actually possible?

The Editorial Goal

Avoid turning every article into “READ MORE! HERE ARE 5 TIPS TO READ FASTER!” Instead, make reading itself interesting enough that people want to read more. The ideal loop is: Interesting story → curiosity → reading → better reading → more reading.